ISRAEL WARTIME READINESS

FIELD GUIDE & CHECKLISTS

Herman
Donkey · Health & Safety Expert

Corn
Sloth · Wellness Expert

Your guides through this document. Neither is a government official.

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Author	Daniel Rosehill + Claude Opus
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Not an official government resource. Based on HFC (Pikud HaOref) published guidance.
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Print this guide and keep it accessible. Affix reflective tape to the cover so it’s visible by torchlight. Prepare at least 3 copies: by the front door, in the go bag, and in the mamad.

QUICK REFERENCE

Tear out or photocopy this page. Post on fridge, in mamad, and in go bag.

☼ DAYTIME AT-HOME POSTURE

- ☐ PHONE — ON PERSON, CHARGED, HFC APP
- ☐ DRESSED — FULL CLOTHES, CLOSED-TOE SHOES
- ☐ KEYS — ON PERSON OR IN/BY DOOR
- ☐ GO BAG — BY DOOR, ZIPPED
- ☐ EXIT — HALLWAY CLEAR, DOOR OPENS QUICKLY
- ☐ BROWSER ALERT — ACTIVE (if at desk)

☾ BEFORE BED POSTURE

- ☐ PHONE — CHARGING, NOT AIRPLANE MODE
- ☐ CLOTHES — LAID OUT BY BED
- ☐ SHOES — CLOSED-TOE BY BED
- ☐ TORCH — NIGHTSTAND, ARM'S REACH
- ☐ GLASSES — BY BED
- ☐ KEYS — BY BED OR BY DOOR
- ☐ GO BAG — BY DOOR, POWER BANK CHARGING
- ☐ EXIT — HALLWAY CLEAR, NOT DOUBLE-LOCKED
- ☐ HEARING — NO EARPLUGS
- ☐ DEPENDENTS — ALL ACCOUNTED FOR

⚠️ NIGHT ALARM — FIRST 30 SECONDS

1. **Feet on floor → into shoes** (same spot every night)
2. **Grab glasses + phone** from nightstand
3. **Pull on clothes** laid out by bed
4. **Torch** if power is out
5. **Move to protected space** or front door
6. **Parents:** one → children, other → go bag (pre-assigned)

LEGEND & SYMBOLS

SYMBOL	MEANING
☐	Checkbox — physically verify and tick off
⚠️	**Critical item** — do not skip under any circumstances
☼	Daytime-specific action
☾	Nighttime-specific action
📱	Smartphone / phone-related
💧	Water / hydration
🛡️	Shelter / protection
🧳	Go bag / supplies
🏠	Home environment
🩺	Medical / first aid
📡	Alerts / emergency communications
👶	Children / dependents

Your Guides

Herman the Donkey — Health & Safety Expert
Appears alongside safety checklists, shelter procedures, and critical items.

Corn the Sloth — Wellness Expert
Appears alongside self-care, wellness, and mental health guidance.

Herman and Corn are the duo behind myweirdprompts.com. They live with Daniel and his wife Hannah in Rehavia, Jerusalem. Neither is a government official, military advisor, or emergency services professional — just two friends who want to help you stay safe and sane.

Chapter 1: How To Use This Document

1.1 Preparation (Before Emergencies)

Print and prepare this checklist before you need it. Do not wait for a siren to figure out what to do.

During routine periods:

- **Print multiple copies** on durable paper (or laminate if possible)
- **Affix a strip of reflective tape** to the cover or top edge — visible when swept with a torch in the dark
- **Bind or staple** the pages together. A document folder or plastic sleeve works well
- Prepare at least **3 copies**:
  - On the fridge or by the front door (the working copy)
  - In the go bag
  - In the mamad / protected space
- **Review and reprint** whenever the checklist is updated

1.2 Running The Checklist

Two-person method (recommended). One person reads each item aloud. The other physically verifies it and responds (e.g. “CHECK”, “DONE”, “NOT YET”). This is the challenge-and-response method used in aviation and military checklists.

CHECKLIST	WHEN TO RUN
Full Master Checklist (Ch. 3)	Start of any escalation or war · After evacuation · Weekly during sustained conflict
Quick Smoke Test — PAWS BED (Ch. 2)	Daily during wartime · Weekly during elevated tension · Monthly during routine
Situational Checklists (Ch. 4)	Every time, during wartime or escalation

⚠️ Items marked with ⚠️ are **critical** — do not skip these under any circumstances.

Chapter 2: Quick Smoke Test — “PAWS BED”

Periodic rapid readiness check. Can be completed in under 2 minutes.

#	CHECK	VERIFY
P	Phone	☐ ON · CHARGED · HFC APP RUNNING · CORRECT AREA
A	Alerts	☐ WIRELESS ALERTS ENABLED · DND OVERRIDE VERIFIED
W	Water	☐ 72-HOUR SUPPLY ACCESSIBLE · NOT EXPIRED
S	Shelter	☐ NEAREST 3 SHELTERS KNOWN · ROUTES WALKABLE
B	Bag	☐ BY DOOR · ZIPPED · CONTENTS VERIFIED
E	Exit	☐ HALLWAY CLEAR · DOOR UNLOCKABLE QUICKLY
D	Dependents	☐ ALL HOUSEHOLD MEMBERS PRESENT OR ACCOUNTED FOR

Mnemonic: PAWS BED

“Check your PAWS before BED”

Chapter 3: Master Checklist

3.1 Technical Systems & Alerts

	ITEM	CHECK
	Smartphone ⚠️	☐ **ON PERSON** *or location known* ☐ **BATTERY LEVEL — OK** *or charging*
	Smartphone Config ⚠️	☐ **POWERED ON** *DND okay; airplane mode not okay* ☐ **LOCATION SERVICES — ENABLED** Home Front Command App: ☐ **INSTALLED** ☐ **CONFIGURED** *See Appendix A* ☐ **RUNNING** ☐ **CORRECT ALERT AREA — VALIDATED** Emergency Wireless Alerts: ☐ **ACTIVATED** *Ensure 'Extreme' threats are alerting*
	Computer	Red Alert app for browser: ☐ **ACTIVE** ☐ **CORRECT LOCATION SET** ☐ **TESTED AND VALIDATED WORKING**

3.2 Home Environment

	ITEM	CHECK
	Water ⚠️	☐ **72 HOURS SUPPLY — READY** *Calc 3L/Person/Day. Resupply when necessary*
	Food ⚠️	☐ **PANTRY GOODS — STOCKED** *See Appendix H for Israeli pantry staples*
	Torch	☐ **ACCESSIBLE** *Hand crank or battery with reserve*
	Hallway ⚠️	☐ **CLEAR** *No obstructions*
	Fire Extinguisher	☐ **ACCESSIBLE** ☐ **SMOKE DETECTOR — INSTALLED AND TESTED**
	Escape Routes	☐ **PRIMARY EXIT IDENTIFIED** ☐ **SECONDARY EXIT IDENTIFIED** *Back door, porch, emergency stairs* ☐ **ROUTES CLEAR OF OBSTACLES**
	Baby Carry	☐ **BY FRONT DOOR**
	Mamad	☐ **PREPARED** *See Appendix C — Mamad Inspection*

*Heavy furniture securing, gas/electricity shutoffs, and fire safety — see **Appendix G: Pre-Emergency Home Safety**. These are preparation tasks, not wartime-active checks.*

3.3 Go Bag

See Chapter 5 §5.1 and Appendix G for detailed go bag guidance.

ITEM	CHECK
Prepared ⚠️	☐ **BY DOOR** ☐ **ZIPPED / SEALED**
Contents (Basic) ⚠️	☐ **PHONE CHARGER AND CABLE — PACKED** ☐ **POWER BANK — PACKED** *Level verified or charging* Medications: ☐ **ESSENTIAL MEDS — PACKED** ☐ **SUPPLY CHECKED AND REPLENISHED** ☐ **TORCH — INSIDE AND CHARGED** ☐ **N95 — PACKED** *One per person*
Contents (Additionals)	☐ **EMERGENCY WHISTLE — PACKED** ☐ **AM/FM RADIO — PACKED** *Battery or charge OK* ☐ **FIRST AID KIT — PACKED AND SUPPLIED** ☐ **TRAVEL ROUTER — PACKED**
Overnight Stays	☐ **RELIGIOUS EFFECTS — PACKED** *Siddur, Tefilin* ☐ **FOOD / DRINK — PACKED** *For longer stays* ☐ **EYE MASK AND EARPLUGS — PACKED** *If sleeping in shelter* ☐ **WATER BOTTLES** ☐ **UMBRELLAS** ☐ **TRAVEL ROUTER + ETHERNET + AC SUPPLY** ☐ **PLUG ADAPTERS / SPLITTERS** ☐ **TENT / BLANKET**
Travel Docs	☐ **PASSPORTS — PACKED AND VALIDATED** ☐ **CASH — ON HAND / PACKED** ☐ **NATIONAL IDS — PACKED** ☐ **TRAVEL DOCS — PACKED**

3.4 People & Dependents

ITEM	CHECK
Dependents ⚠️	All household members: ☐ **PRESENT** or ☐ **ACCOUNTED FOR AND CONTACTABLE**

3.5 Babies & Young Children

ITEM	CHECK
Essential Supplies ⚠️	PACKED in Go Bag: ☐ **Diapers** ☐ **Wipes** ☐ **Pacifier** ☐ **Formula** ☐ **Bottle** ☐ **Changing mat + privacy**
Ready To Go ⚠️	☐ **CLOTHED** *Or clothes by bed* ☐ **BABYWEAR BY DOOR** ☐ **FED** *If needed* ☐ **CLEANED** *If needed*

3.6 Person & Personal Effects

	ITEM	DAYTIME	NIGHT
	Clothing ⚠️	☐ **DRESSED** *For weather*	☐ **BY DOOR / BY BED / SLEEPING IN**
	Footwear ⚠️	☐ **WEARING — CLOSED TOE**	☐ **BY DOOR / BY BED — CLOSED TOE**
	Keys ⚠️	☐ **ON PERSON OR BY DOOR**	
	Wallet		
	Meds	☐ **TAKEN ON SCHEDULE**	
	Rest	☐ **TAKEN WHEN POSSIBLE**	
	Hygiene	☐ **SHOWER** *As soon as possible*	

		☐ BRUSH TEETH ☐ TENDED TO GENERALLY	
	Toilet	☐ TAKEN AS SOON AS POSSIBLE	

3.7 Situational Awareness

	CATEGORY	ACTIONS	FREQUENCY
	News	☐ SCANNED	*Every 1–3 hours*
	Alert Area	☐ KNOWN	
	Shelters	☐ NEAREST 3 KNOWN ☐ ACCESSIBILITY VERIFIED ☐ OPEN / HOURS NOTED ☐ EXIT TIMED	*Once per emergency*
	HFC App	☐ CHECKED *Current advice*	*Once per day*
	Supplies	☐ WATER + FOOD REPLACED ☐ BATTERIES + ELECTRONICS CHECKED	*Water/food: 3 months* *Batteries: 6 months*

Chapter 4: Situational Checklists

4.1 Daytime At-Home Posture

Quick status check while at home during the day. Run after waking, and repeat after any disruption.

	ITEM	CHECK
	Phone ⚠️	☐ ON PERSON *Or within arm's reach* ☐ CHARGED OR CHARGING ☐ HFC APP RUNNING
	Dressed ⚠️	☐ FULLY CLOTHED ☐ CLOSED-TOE SHOES ON *Not slippers, not barefoot*
	Keys ⚠️	☐ ON PERSON OR IN/BY DOOR
	Go Bag ⚠️	☐ BY DOOR ☐ ZIPPED
	Exit Route ⚠️	☐ HALLWAY CLEAR ☐ FRONT DOOR CAN BE OPENED QUICKLY
	Browser Alert	☐ RED ALERT EXTENSION ACTIVE *If working at desk*

Working from home during wartime:

- Stay dressed and shoed — do not slip into pyjamas "just at the desk"
- Headphones: use one ear only, or keep volume low enough to hear a siren
- Save work frequently — you may need to abandon your desk mid-sentence
- At the start of any call: *"I'm in an active alert zone. I may need to leave abruptly."*

4.2 After Returning From Shelter (Reset)

Run immediately after the all-clear. Restore full readiness before the next alert.

	ITEM	CHECK
	Go Bag ⚠️	☐ BACK BY DOOR ☐ RE-ZIPPED *Did anything fall out? Put it back now*
	Phone ⚠️	☐ PUT ON CHARGE *If battery dropped* ☐ HFC APP STILL RUNNING
	Power Bank	☐ PUT ON CHARGE *May have been used in shelter*
	Water	☐ RESUPPLY *If you drank from emergency stock*
	Clothes & Shoes	☐ BACK IN POSITION *By bed (night) or on person (day)*
	Torch	☐ BACK IN POSITION *Nightstand or go bag*
	Dependents ⚠️	☐ ALL ACCOUNTED FOR AND SAFE

Self-Care — Do these NOW, not later. You don't know when the next alert comes.

☐ EAT FOOD
Stress suppresses appetite — eat anyway. You need the energy.

☐ DRINK WATER

☐ USE THE TOILET

☐ SHOWER
If time and situation allow

☐ REST
When possible

Children:

☐ FED ☐ WATERED ☐ TOILETED / CHANGED

☐ CLEANED

If possible ☐ RESTED
Put down for nap if timing allows

4.3 Before Showering

	ITEM	CHECK
	News Check ⚠️	☐ **SITUATION SCANNED** *No active alerts in your area*
	Phone ⚠️	☐ **VOLUME AT MAXIMUM** *Must be audible over water* ☐ **IN BATHROOM OR JUST OUTSIDE DOOR**
	Clothes ⚠️	☐ **FULL OUTFIT IN BATHROOM** *Ready to throw on immediately — not in another room*
	Footwear ⚠️	☐ **CLOSED-TOE SHOES BY BATHROOM DOOR**
	Towel	☐ **WITHIN REACH** *For rapid dry-off*
	Door	☐ **BATHROOM DOOR UNLOCKED**
	Keep It Short ⚠️	☐ **MINIMISE TIME** *You are at your most vulnerable; be quick*

4.4 Before Bed

	ITEM	CHECK
	News Check	☐ **SITUATION SCANNED** *Assess if safe to sleep at home*
	Phone ⚠️	☐ **CHARGING OR CHARGED** ☐ **NOT IN AIRPLANE MODE** *DND/silent OK* ☐ **LOCATION SERVICES ON** ☐ **HFC APP — NOTIFICATION + OVERRIDE PERMISSIONS**
	Clothes ⚠️	☐ **LAID OUT BY BED** *Full outfit ready in seconds*
	Footwear ⚠️	☐ **CLOSED-TOE SHOES BY BED** *Ready to step into immediately*

	Torch	☐ **WITHIN ARM'S REACH** *On nightstand, not buried in go bag*
	Glasses	☐ **BY BED** *Same spot every night*
🔑	**Keys**	☐ **ACCESSIBLE** *By bed or on hook by front door*
👜	**Go Bag** ⚠️	☐ **BY DOOR** ☐ **CONTENTS VERIFIED** ☐ **POWER BANK ON CHARGE**
🚪	**Exit Route** ⚠️	☐ **HALLWAY CLEAR** *Can navigate in the dark* ☐ **FRONT DOOR NOT DOUBLE-LOCKED**
📢	**Hearing** ⚠️	☐ **NO EARPLUGS** *You must hear the siren and phone alert*
👶	**Dependents** ⚠️	☐ **ALL ACCOUNTED FOR** ☐ **BABY — CLOTHED OR CLOTHES BY BED, BABYWEAR BY DOOR**

4.5 Before Leaving Home

	ITEM	CHECK
	Go Bag ⚠️	☐ TAKING WITH YOU
	News Check ⚠️	☐ SITUATION SCANNED BEFORE DEPARTURE *Check HFC app and news for active alerts*
	Shelters ⚠️	☐ NEAREST SHELTERS IDENTIFIED *At destination and along route*
	Time To Shelter	☐ KNOWN FOR DESTINATION AREA
	Phone ⚠️	☐ CHARGED ☐ HFC APP RUNNING ☐ LOCATION ON
	Car Fuel	☐ AT LEAST HALF A TANK
	Household Notified	☐ DESTINATION AND RETURN TIME COMMUNICATED

Chapter 5: Guidance Notes

5.1 Choosing a Go Bag

Your go bag is the single most important physical item in your readiness kit. **Use a backpack, not a tote bag.** See Appendix G for a full packing list.

You need both hands free. You may be carrying a child, holding a torch, opening doors, or navigating stairs in the dark.

✓ What to look for

- **Two shoulder straps** with padding
- **Chest strap and/or waist strap**
- **Water-resistant material**
- **30–40 litre capacity**
- **Multiple compartments** — find things in the dark by feel
- **Durable zips**
- **Dark or neutral colour**

× What to avoid

- Tote bags, drawstring bags, single-strap slings
- Wheeled luggage — useless on stairs or rubble
- Very large bags (60L+) — too heavy
- Fashion bags with no structure

Once selected

- Affix **reflective tape** to straps
- Assign each item a **fixed pocket**
- Keep it **by the front door**

5.2 In Shelter — When To Leave

> ⚠️ **Wait for the all-clear.** Do NOT leave your protected space until you receive an all-clear from HFC (via the app, official media, or the all-clear siren pattern).

If you have no connectivity (phone dead, no signal, no internet):

- **Stay in shelter.** The default when you have no information is to remain in place
- Do NOT assume the situation is over because it has been quiet
- If you have a radio, tune to a national station
- **When in doubt, stay longer.** Leaving too early is far more dangerous than staying too long

Many casualties occur because people leave shelter prematurely.

5.3 In Shelter — Behaviour

Children

- **Use a calm, steady voice.** Children take their cues from adults
- **Explain simply:** *"We're in our safe room. We wait here until we're told it's safe"*
- **Have a comfort item ready** — one in the mamad, one in the go bag
- **Hold young children close** — physical contact is reassuring
- **Do not lie** — children hear sirens. Acknowledge and redirect to the plan

General

- **Sit against an inner wall,** below window line
- **Do NOT use elevators** during or after an alert
- **Do NOT go outside to photograph interceptions** — falling debris causes injuries
- **Keep the mamad/shelter door closed** until the all-clear
- If you smell gas or see structural damage, **move to alternative shelter** and call **102**
- After the all-clear, **send a brief safety confirmation** to family
- **Do not spread unverified information**

5.4 Moving Safely to a Public Shelter

The journey to shelter is one of the most dangerous moments.

Before you move

- Know where you're going
- Grab go bag only if on the route
- Secure children first, then move

On the stairs

- **Hold the handrail**
- Do NOT run — fast, controlled walk

Outside

- **Watch the ground** — glass, uneven pavement
- Do NOT run across roads without looking
- Wear closed-toe shoes
- If shelter unreachable, enter nearest building or lie flat

At the shelter door

- Stay to one side
- Let children, elderly, mobility-limited enter first
- Move away from entrance once inside

⚠️ **Common injuries:** Falls on stairs (wet, dark, socks) · Tripping on uneven ground · Cuts from bare feet on debris · Collisions in narrow hallways · Panic-related sprains

5.5 Waking Up to a Night Alarm ☾

This is one of the hardest scenarios. Everything in §4.4 exists to make this moment survivable on autopilot.

The first 5 seconds

1. **Siren or phone alert wakes you.** Do not process. Just move
2. **Feet on floor → into shoes.** Same spot every night
3. **Grab glasses** and **phone**

The next 10–20 seconds

4. **Clothes:** Pull on whatever is laid out. Speed over appearance
5. **Grab torch** from nightstand if power is out
6. **Move to protected space** or front door

For parents

7. One parent → child/children. Other → go bag (pre-assigned roles)
8. Carry baby in babywear that's by the door. Do not stop to dress them

Do not think. Follow the procedure. Every decision at 3am is one you should have made before bed.
Do not check your phone. The siren means go. Read details in the shelter.
It gets easier. After 2–3 night alarms, the routine becomes automatic.

5.6 Fighting Alert Fatigue

After days or weeks of alerts, the temptation to stop reacting is enormous. This is **alert fatigue** — a normal neurological process, not a character flaw. But it kills people.

Why it happens:
- Repeated exposure reduces your response — normal neurology
- Most alerts end without personal impact, reinforcing false safety beliefs
- Fatigue, stress, and disrupted sleep degrade motivation
- Social pressure: if neighbours aren't sheltering, you feel permission to stop

How to fight it:
- **Reframe every alert as the first one.** The one you skip could be the one that matters
- **Use the checklist mechanically.** They work when your judgment doesn't
- **Keep your shoes on.** The single biggest predictor of whether someone will shelter
- **Lower the effort, not the standard.** Sleep in clothes by the door — that's adapting
- **Talk about it.** "I'm feeling alert fatigue. Let's keep going to shelter."
- **Remember:** Civilian injuries spike in weeks 2–3, when alert fatigue peaks

5.7 Wellness During Protracted Conflict

Wars lasting weeks create cumulative strain different from acute stress. Readiness includes taking care of yourself.

Physical

- **Sleep when you can.** Any sleep is better than none
- **Eat regular meals.** Stress suppresses appetite — eat anyway
- **Drink water.** Dehydration amplifies fatigue
- **Shower when you can.** Hygiene is a morale multiplier
- **Move your body.** Even 10 minutes of stretching
- **Manage medication.** Maintain a 72-hour buffer

Psychological

- **Limit news** to every 1–3 hours — don't doom-scroll
- **Maintain routines.** Even small ones stabilise
- **Stay connected.** Isolation amplifies stress
- **Acknowledge the difficulty.** "This is hard" is not weakness
- **Watch for warning signs** — insomnia, inability to eat, withdrawal, rage, numbness
- Call **ERAN (1201)** or **NATAL (1-800-363-363)**

Children need extra reassurance. Maintain bedtime routines. Don't dismiss fears — validate and redirect: *"Yes, it's scary. And we have a plan, and our safe room works, and we're together."*

Give yourself permission to function imperfectly. Safety first, then wellbeing, then everything else.

5.8 Caring for Elderly Neighbours & Vulnerable People

Before the escalation

- **Know your neighbours** — especially those living alone or with limitations
- **Exchange phone numbers**
- **Establish a buddy system** — check on each other after every alert
- **Know who holds a spare key**

During alerts

- Check on elderly/mobility-limited neighbours **on your way** (only if safe)
- Help them to safest position: inner wall, away from windows
- After the all-clear, **knock on their door** — 10 seconds

Ongoing support

- Check **food, water, medications**
- Help with **technology** — phone charged, HFC app configured
- **Offer to include them** in supply runs
- If distressed: **118** (Welfare Ministry) or ***8840** (Senior Citizens)

5.9 Using Communal / Public Shelters

> ⚠️ HFC maintains official shelter information. Check the HFC app or oref.org.il. This guidance supplements — does not replace — official instructions.

Finding shelters: HFC app, building committee (vaad bayit), or physically walk to your nearest 3.

Access: Many are locked — find the keyholder. Some have restricted hours. Report storage/access issues to municipality.

Etiquette:
- Make space — move to the back
- **Priority:** children, elderly, pregnant women, people with disabilities
- Keep noise down
- Share resources with those who arrive without supplies
- **Pets:** many shelters do not allow animals — check in advance
- Bring something for children to do

5.10 OPSEC & Information Discipline

> ⚠️ During wartime, what you share online can endanger lives — including your own.

Do NOT share

- **Exact locations of impacts**
- **Military or emergency activity**
- **Photos/videos** revealing locations
- **Casualty info** before families notified

Do NOT believe

- Unverified reports on X, Telegram, WhatsApp
- “Breaking” news from unknown accounts
- Dramatic unconfirmed claims
- Screenshots from unverified sources

Do: Use **official sources** (HFC app, IDF Spokesperson, Israel Police, established media). Check before sharing. Tell others to delete sensitive location info.

Even well-intentioned sharing can be lethal OPSEC. When in doubt, don’t post.

5.11 Preliminary Guidelines (Advance Warning)

HFC provides **3–5 minute advance warning** for attacks from distant sources (e.g. Yemen).

- Notification via HFC app **before** the siren
- Does **NOT** require shelter entry
- It means: **prepare.** Shoes on. Phone located. Know where you're going

What to do:

- **At home:** Ensure shoes, keys, phone, go bag in position
- **Driving:** Look for a solid building to pull over near
- **On public transport:** Follow crew instructions; bend below window line
- **Outside with children:** Identify nearest shelter; gather children close

When the actual alert sounds: follow standard shelter procedure (Appendix D).

5.12 Terrorist Infiltration / Hostile Aerial Vehicle

⚠️ **Different protocol** from rocket/missile response. Do NOT follow standard shelter procedure.

1. **Enter the nearest building** immediately
2. **Lock the door.** Barricade if needed
3. **Lights off.** Stay in darkness
4. **Stay silent.** TV, radio, noise off
5. **Below window line.** Away from windows and exterior walls
6. **Do NOT share your location on social media**
7. **Do NOT open the door** except for identified security forces
8. **If rocket alert sounds during infiltration: stay where you are**
9. **Wait for security forces** — may take hours

Mamad door: Do NOT remove the handle. Block from inside with heavy object.

Licensed weapon holders: Aim at front door. Fire only on positive ID.[1]

[1]Based on Home Front Command protocol as of 20 March 2026. Always verify with current HFC guidance at oref.org.il.

Chapter 6: Shabbat / Hag (Observant Jews)

When phones are off and sirens are the only alert. Prepare before candle-lighting.

6.1 Before Shabbat / Hag

	ITEM	CHECK
	Channel 14 / Gal Shaket ⚠️	☐ PLAYING ON TV BEFORE SHABBAT ☐ VOLUME TESTED — AUDIBLE FROM BEDROOMS *Verify TV not muted*
	Emergency Radio ⚠️	☐ FREQUENCY AND OPERATION VERIFIED ☐ VOLUME AT MAXIMUM ☐ POWER SUPPLY — AC OR BATTERIES
	Go Bag	☐ BY DOOR ☐ CONTENTS VERIFIED
	Shabbat Supplies	☐ PACKED *Siddur, kiddush cup, snacks for shelter*
	Shoes ⚠️	☐ CLOSED-TOE BY BED AND BY DOOR *Do not rely on slippers*
	Clothes	☐ LAID OUT BY BED *Full outfit, not just pyjamas*
	Keys	☐ BY FRONT DOOR
	Torch	☐ WITHIN ARM'S REACH *Pre-set on nightstand*

Pikuach nefesh (preservation of life) overrides all Shabbat prohibitions. If a siren sounds, you may — and **must** — use your phone, carry items, and do whatever is needed to reach shelter safely. This is not a leniency; it is **halacha**.

6.2 During Shabbat / Hag

- **Sirens are your primary alert.** Keep windows slightly open so you can hear outdoor sirens
- **TV or radio must stay on and audible** throughout Shabbat — this is your only real-time information source
- **Know your shelter route in the dark** — no phone torch available (unless siren sounds)
- After an alert, **stay in shelter for 10 minutes or until all-clear on TV/radio**

⚠️ **If you hear a siren on Shabbat:** Move to shelter immediately. Carry children, phone, go bag — whatever you need. There is no halachic question here.[2]

[2] Based on Home Front Command protocol as of 20 March 2026. Consult your rabbi for specific halachic guidance.

Appendix A: Home Front Command App (Android)

ITEM	CHECK
Installed	☐ VERIFIED
Up To Date	☐ VERIFIED *No pending updates*
Alerting Area	☐ SET AND IDENTIFIED
Permissions	☐ DND EXEMPTION — VERIFIED ☐ REMOVE PERMISSIONS IF UNUSED — DISABLED ☐ BATTERY OPTIMISATIONS — DISABLED ☐ BACKGROUND DATA ACCESS — PERMITTED ☐ DISPLAY OVER OTHER APPS — GRANTED

Appendix B: Emergency Numbers

NUMBER	SERVICE	NOTES
100	**Israel Police**	Unexploded ordnance, security incidents *SMS: 052-2020100*
101	**Magen David Adom**	Injuries, first aid, medical emergencies *SMS: 052-7000101*
102	**Fire & Rescue**	Fires, trapped persons, structural collapse *SMS: 050-5960735*
103	**Electric Corp.**	Power outages, electrical hazards *SMS: 055-7000103*
104	**Home Front Command**	Guidelines, alerts, emergency info *SMS: 052-9104104*
106–109	**Municipality**	Local information, municipal assistance
110	**Police Info**	Road blocks, police information

NUMBER	SUPPORT & WELFARE
118	Welfare Ministry — Information and assistance
1201	ERAN — Emotional first aid hotline
***8840**	Senior Citizens — Ministry of Social Equality
***9696**	National Insurance — Counselling
105	Missing persons hotline
1-800-363-363	NATAL — Trauma support
03-6919765	NAAN — Youth crisis line
***4954**	Tax Authority — War property damage claims
1-700-707-889	Population Authority — Foreign workers
04-7702651	Immigration assistance (English)

⚠️ ☐ **PRINTED COPY POSTED AT HOME**

Fridge or front door, and in go bag. Do NOT rely on phone alone.

Appendix C: Mamad (Protected Space) Inspection

Based on Home Front Command guidelines for residential protected spaces.[3]

Structural Inspection

ITEM	CHECK
Blast Door	☐ OPENS AND CLOSES EASILY ☐ HANDLE TURNS 90° UPWARD ☐ DOUBLE LOCK FUNCTIONS
Door Seal	☐ RUBBER INSULATION PRESENT *Not dried out or cracked — replace if brittle*
Light Test	☐ NO LIGHT PENETRATION WHEN SEALED *Light = inadequate seal*
Steel Outer Window	☐ OPENS AND CLOSES EASILY
Glass Inner Window	☐ FUNCTIONS CORRECTLY *Double-wing: **remove both wings** during escalation and store outside room*
Ventilation Pipes	☐ RUBBER INSULATION INTACT ☐ STEEL COVER SCREWS TIGHTEN FULLY

Contents & Safety

ITEM	CHECK
Flammable / Hazardous	☐ NONE *No flammable, hazardous, or toxic materials*
Glass / Ceramics	☐ NONE *No glass, ceramic, porcelain that could shatter*
Heavy Items	☐ SHELVES AND HEAVY ITEMS FIXED TO WALLS
Gas Tanks	☐ 3+ METRES FROM PROTECTED ROOM WALLS
Emergency Supplies	☐ STORED INSIDE OR IMMEDIATELY NEARBY

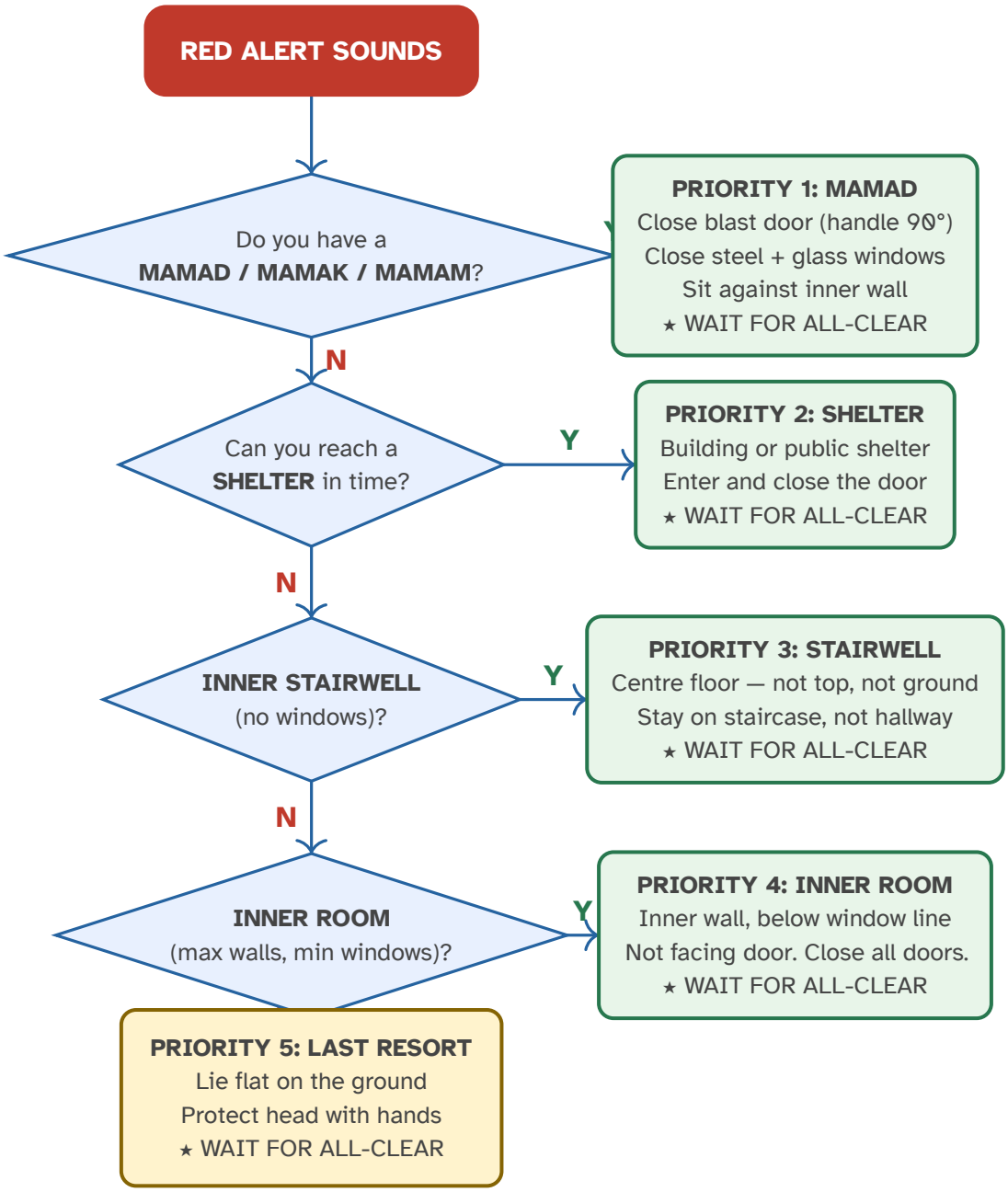
[3] HFC mamad inspection protocol as of 20 March 2026.

Ceiling Fan	☐ **NONE INSTALLED** *Prohibited in mamads*
Ventilation	☐ **ROOM IS VENTILATED IF USED AS BEDROOM** *Must NOT be used as kitchen, bathroom, or washroom*

Appendix D: Protected Space Decision Tree

When a Red Alert sounds, choose the highest-priority option you can reach.[4]

⚠️ **WHEN TO LEAVE:** Stay for **10 minutes OR until all-clear** — whichever comes later.
Siren duration = defense time. Border areas may have 15 seconds or less.



[4] Based on Home Front Command protocol as of 20 March 2026.

⛔ **NOT valid:** Kitchen · Bathroom · Toilet · Building entrance lobby · Caravans / prefab · Areas with ceramics, porcelain, or glass

Stairwell positioning: 3+ floors: at least 2 floors above you. 3-storey building: middle floor only.

Appendix E: Hebrew Glossary

Key terms you will hear on the news, in alerts, and from neighbours.

HEBREW	TRANSLITERATION	MEANING
אזעקה	**Azaka**	Alert / siren
צבע אדום	**Tzeva Adom**	“Red Color” — the Red Alert warning
ממ״ד	**Mamad**	Apartment-level protected space
ממ״ק	**Mamak**	Floor-level protected space
ממ״מ	**Mamam**	Institutional protected space
מקלט	**Miklat**	Public bomb shelter
חדר מדרגות	**Khadar Madregot**	Stairwell
פיקוד העורף	**Pikud HaOref**	Home Front Command (HFC)
התרעה מקדימה	**Hatra’a Makdima**	Preliminary guideline
הנחיה מיוחדת	**Hankhaya Meyukhedet**	Special instruction
ירי רקטות	**Yeri Raketot**	Rocket fire
חדירת כלי טיס עוין	**Khadirat Kli Tis Oyein**	Hostile aerial vehicle
חדירת מחבלים	**Khadirat Mekhabblim**	Terrorist infiltration
רעידת אדמה	**Re’idat Adama**	Earthquake
חומרים מסוכנים	**Khomarim Mesukanim**	Hazardous materials
ניתן לצאת	**Nitan Latzeit**	“You may exit” — all-clear
היכנסו למרחב המוגן	**Hikansu LaMerkhav HaMugan**	“Enter the protected space”
שהו במרחב המוגן	**Shehu BaMerkhav HaMugan**	“Remain in the protected space”
דלת פלדה	**Delet Plada**	Steel/blast door
חלון פלדה	**Khalon Plada**	Steel window
תריס	**Tris**	Shutter
פנס	**Panas**	Torch / flashlight
תיק חירום	**Tik Kherum**	Emergency bag (go bag)
מד״א	**Mada**	Magen David Adom
צה״ל	**Tzahal**	IDF
משטרה	**Mishtara**	Police

כבאות	**Kaba’ut**	Fire service
ועד בית	**Va’ad Bayit**	Building committee
עורף	**Oref**	Home front (civilian rear)

Appendix F: Emergency Radio Frequencies

If phone and internet are down, a battery-powered or hand-crank AM/FM radio is your lifeline.

STATION	FM	AM	NOTES
Reshet Bet (כאן ב׳)	95.5 / 97.8	657 / 1206	Primary national news; HFC announcements
Galei Tzahal (גלצ)	102.3 / 103.0	—	IDF Radio; security updates
Reshet Aleph (כאן א׳)	100.3 / 104.0	531 / 1008	National talk and news
Reshet Gimel (כאן ג׳)	97.0 / 99.0	—	Hebrew music + news bulletins
Kol Israel Arabic	99.5	576 / 711	Arabic-language alerts
Reka (כאן רק״ע)	101.5 / 104.5	972	Russian/Amharic/French/English

- FM frequencies vary by region — scan nearby if no signal
- **AM is more reliable** during emergencies — longer range, works better inside buildings
- During emergencies, all stations simulcast HFC announcements
- **Write your local frequencies on the radio itself** with a permanent marker

Appendix G: Pre-Emergency Home Safety

These tasks should be completed before an emergency — during routine periods. They are not wartime-active checks.

	ITEM	CHECK
	Bookcases & Shelves	☐ **SECURED TO WALLS WITH L-BRACKETS OR STRAPS** ☐ **HEAVY OBJECTS STORED LOW** *Not above head height*
	Appliances	☐ **WHEELED APPLIANCES — WHEELS LOCKED** ☐ **HEAVY APPLIANCES — STABLE AND SECURED**
	Gas Shutoff ⚠️	☐ **LOCATION KNOWN** *By all household members* ☐ **ALL MEMBERS KNOW HOW TO SHUT OFF** ☐ **OPERATION TESTED** *Turn clockwise 90° to close*
	Electricity Shutoff ⚠️	☐ **LOCATION KNOWN** *Main breaker box* ☐ **ALL MEMBERS KNOW HOW TO SHUT OFF**
	Fire Extinguisher	☐ **ACCESSIBLE AND NOT EXPIRED** ☐ **ALL MEMBERS KNOW HOW TO USE**
	Smoke Detector	☐ **INSTALLED — ONE PER FLOOR MINIMUM** ☐ **TESTED AND WORKING** *Test monthly* ☐ **BATTERIES REPLACED ANNUALLY**
	Water Heater	☐ **STRAPPED TO WALL** *To prevent toppling*
	Windows	☐ **NO GLASS OBJECTS ON WINDOWSILLS** *Can shatter into projectiles* ☐ **BLINDS / SHUTTERS — FUNCTIONAL**

Schedule a home safety walk-through every 6 months, or immediately after moving. These items take 1–2 hours to set up but dramatically reduce injury risk during shaking from nearby impacts.

Appendix H: Go Bag Recommendations

A detailed packing list. Adapt to your household size and needs.

Tier 1 — Always Packed (Critical)

	ITEM	NOTES
	Phone charger + cable	One per device type
	Power bank	10,000+ mAh; check charge weekly
	Essential medications	7-day supply; rotate monthly
	Torch + spare batteries	Or hand-crank torch
	N95 masks	One per person; sealed in bag
	Water bottle	1L minimum per person
	Emergency whistle	Audible from under debris
	First aid kit	Bandages, antiseptic, pain relief, scissors
	Copies of this guide	Laminated or in waterproof sleeve

Tier 2 — Recommended Additions

	ITEM	NOTES
	AM/FM radio	Battery or crank; write frequencies on it
	Travel router + ethernet	For shelter with wired internet
	Plug adapters / splitters	Shelter outlets are shared
	Cash (NIS)	Small bills; ATMs may be down
	Passports + national IDs	Copies in waterproof pouch
	Emergency contact list	Printed; phones die
	Multi-tool or Swiss Army knife	Blade, opener, screwdriver
	Duct tape + zip ties	Universal repair
	Permanent marker + paper	For notes if no phone

Tier 3 — Extended Stay (4+ Hours / Overnight)

	ITEM	NOTES
	Non-perishable snacks	Energy bars, nuts, dried fruit, crackers
	Extra water	3L per person per day
	Eye mask + earplugs	Sleep in shared shelter
	Blanket or emergency bivvy	Aluminium emergency blankets are compact
	Change of clothes	Including socks and underwear
	Toiletries bag	Toothbrush, wet wipes, hand sanitiser
	Entertainment	Book, cards, colouring for children
	Religious items	Siddur, tefillin (if applicable)
	Umbrella	For walking to shelter in rain

Rotation schedule: Check medications and power bank monthly. Rotate food and water every 3 months. Replace batteries every 6 months. Update documents annually.

Appendix I: Emergency Pantry Staples (Israel)

Items commonly available in Israeli supermarkets. Focus on shelf-stable, calorie-dense, minimal-preparation foods. All items below are available kosher.

Water

- **3 litres per person per day** (drinking + basic hygiene)
- **Minimum 72-hour supply** → 9L per person
- Store in sealed containers away from sunlight
- Rotate every 6 months
- **Tip:** freeze extra bottles — they keep food cold if power fails and become drinking water as they melt

Staple Foods

CATEGORY	ITEMS	SHELF LIFE
Canned Goods	Tuna (שימורי טונה) · Chickpeas (חומוס) · Corn · Beans · Tomatoes · Sardines	2–5 years
Grains & Starches	Rice · Pasta · Couscous · Matza / crackers · Instant oatmeal	1–2 years
Proteins	Canned tuna/sardines · Tahini (טחינה) · Halva (חלווה) · Peanut butter · Canned hummus	6–24 months
Dried Goods	Lentils (עדשים) · Dried fruits · Nuts · Sunflower seeds · Bamba	6–12 months
Quick Energy	Energy bars · Chocolate · Honey · Jam · Sugar · Dates (תמרים)	6–24 months
Beverages	Instant coffee · Tea bags · Powdered milk · Juice boxes (UHT)	6–12 months
Cooking Aids	Salt · Cooking oil · Instant soup mix (קנורר) · Spices	1–2 years
Baby / Special	Formula · Baby food jars · Gluten-free alternatives · Ensure/Ensure-type drinks	Check labels

Practical Tips

- **Buy items you actually eat** — rotate through normal cooking
- **FIFO:** First In, First Out — new stock to the back
- **Label everything** with purchase date
- **No power = no fridge:** plan for shelf-stable only
- **Can opener:** keep one with the pantry supplies (not in a drawer you won't find in the dark)
- **Kashrut:** all items above are available with hechsher at major Israeli chains (Shufersal, Rami Levy, Yochananof)
- **Pesach:** maintain a separate small stock of kitniyot-free / Pesach-suitable items if needed
- **Babies:** maintain **at least 2 weeks** of formula at all times

- **Special diets:** stock according to medical needs first

Don't panic-buy. Build your stock gradually over 2–3 weeks. Add a few extra items to each regular shop. This is sustainable and doesn't empty shelves for others.

References

All sources from the Israel Home Front Command (Pikud HaOref) English-language National Emergency Portal. Accessed and archived: 20 March 2026.

TOPIC	SOURCE
Protection Guidelines	oref.org.il/eng/emergencies/protection-guidelines
Emergency Supplies	oref.org.il/eng/articles/info/preparing-protected-space/1201
Reaching Shelter	oref.org.il/eng/articles/protection-guidelines/preparing-protected-space/1103
Residential Protected Space	oref.org.il/eng/articles/info/preparing-protected-space/1205
Types of Protected Area	oref.org.il/eng/articles/info/preparing-protected-space/1212
Communal Shelter Preparation	oref.org.il/eng/articles/protection-guidelines/preparing-protected-space/1704
Emergency Phone Numbers	oref.org.il/eng/articles/emergency-preparedness/preparing-routine/1211
FAQs — All	oref.org.il/eng/questions-answers/faq
FAQs — Rockets & Missiles	oref.org.il/eng/questions-answers/rockets-missles-faq
FAQs — Defensive Guidelines	oref.org.il/eng/questions-answers/defensive-guidelines-faq
FAQs — Receiving Alerts	oref.org.il/eng/questions-answers/receiving-alerts-faq
FAQs — Emergency Preparedness	oref.org.il/eng/questions-answers/emergency-coping-faq

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